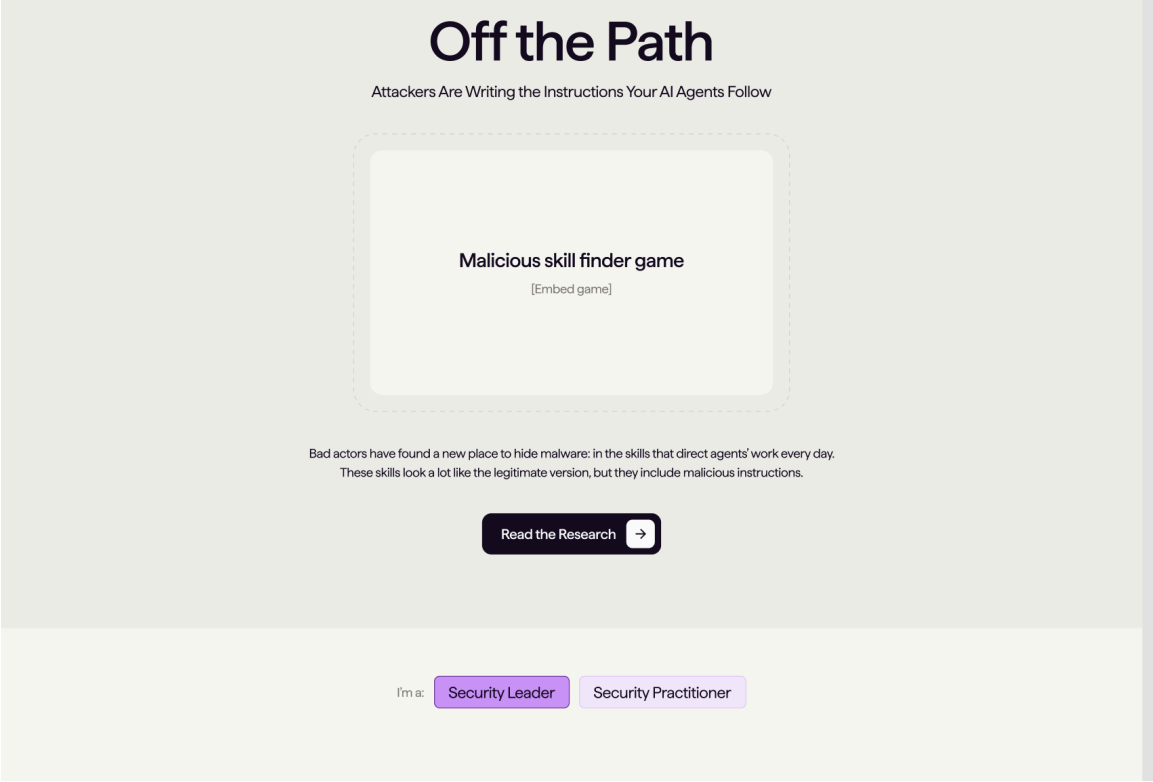
Off the Path - Game and Campaign Concept

Oct 14, 2026 · @Amit Straus

That's Not My Grandma is a short pixel adventure on the Off the Path research page that lets players feel how a helpful AI skill can carry an attacker's instructions.

The campaign at a glance

The Off the Path page leads with one claim, **"Attackers Are Writing the Instructions Your AI Agents Follow,"** and a game that makes the claim playable before the reader opens the research.



The page runs top to bottom in four parts:

1. **Headline and subhead.** The research thesis in one line.
2. **Game embed.** The "Malicious skill finder game" slot, currently a placeholder.
3. **Short pitch and button.** Bad actors now hide malware in the skills that direct agents' daily work, and the *Read the Research* button sends players to the full findings.
4. **Audience toggle.** An "I'm a" switch between Security Leader and Security Practitioner, so the page below can speak to each.

The idea: a fairy tale as an agent security lesson

A skill can deliver what it promises and still follow an attacker's instructions, so every character in the forest maps to a piece of the real threat.

In the story	In the research	What it teaches
Red Riding Hood	The AI agent	The agent has a legitimate task and will use whatever it is handed.
Her delivery to Grandma	The intended task	The goal stays the same while the route can be tampered with.
Forest characters and their offers (compass, translator, lantern)	Third-party skills and capabilities	Useful help arrives from sources the agent did not write.
A friendly character passing a skill along	A compromised skill in the supply chain	The sender can be honest and the skill still malicious.
The wolf	The attacker	Hidden instructions sit behind a useful offer.
Allow, Restrict, Reject	Review of a skill before use	The player decides what the agent is permitted to do.
Grandma's cottage	The outcome	Each choice leads back to the instruction that caused it.

How it plays: four beats

Players guide Red through a top-down forest, question each character's offer, inspect what the skill really does, and reach Grandma's cottage.



1. **Explore.** Walk the forest with a joystick or keyboard, with the quest marker "Find Grandma" always visible. Characters offer skills such as a compass, translator or lantern.
2. **Question.** Talk to the character offering the skill. In the board, the rabbit offers a compass and the player can ask *What does it need?*, *Who made it?* or *Show me.* A friendly character may unknowingly pass along a compromised skill.
3. **Inspect.** Open the skill card. The compass, called Cottage Finder, promises to show a path to Grandma's cottage, but it also copies the cottage key. The player chooses **Allow**, **Restrict** or **Reject**, and the basket at the bottom shows what Red is carrying.
4. **Arrive.** Reach the cottage and see the outcome. Useful skills open routes, while hidden actions can expose information or help the wolf. A short recap ties each consequential choice to the hidden instruction behind it.

Look and feel

The game keeps the approved pixel art, a green daytime forest, Red's red cloak and a note of quiet suspense, while the interface wears Cyera's current website colors.

Color	Hex	Where it is used
Dark violet	`#160923`	Panel headers and the darkest interface surfaces
Lilac	`#D390FF`	Highlights, the selected dialogue option, controls
Lavender	`#E8C6FF`	Soft accents and tints
Warm off-white	`#EEEDE7`	Page and board background
Alabaster	`#F6F5F1`	Dialogue panels

Palette source: cyera.com.

First version and the takeaway

The first version is one forest, four characters, three skills and a final cottage encounter, and its ending leads straight to *Read the Research*.

A skill can do what it promises and still follow an attacker's instructions. Players should leave asking: who wrote these instructions, and what will my agent actually do?

Sources

- Off the Path game summary (supplied document): story, mechanics, look and feel, and first-version scope.
- Off the Path pixel RPG concept board (supplied image): the four gameplay panels.
- Off the Path landing page screenshot, 13 Oct 2026 (supplied image): campaign headline, game embed slot and page structure.
- cyera.com: palette source named in the summary.